

Tips & Tricks**74**

Our tips to master Google Allo and Assistant, while setting up smart monitoring tools for your PC's status.

Q&A**78**

We tackle defective keyboards, mice, GPUs, internet connectivity issues and some more automatic shutdowns.

Get your Android device Xposed!

Follow this workshop and you'll know how to tweak every aspect of your Android instance. It's time to get more out of your phone and really put it to work.

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The Android OS is an open source project and one of the largest ones till date. It has millions of developers worldwide working on just the system and many more developing apps for the platform.

The huge appeal with the Android OS is with the customisation for OEMs. OEMs are trying hard to differentiate from one another, and apart from hardware, the software is the biggest differentiator. The average consumer might be satisfied with stock features as seen on Google's flagship lineup. But there are ways the Android system can be customised those who want to go the extra mile. One of the major ways to modify the system configuration not accessible to the common users is by installing a framework called Xposed.

Xposed installation

Xposed is a framework which installs on top of your existing system, giving you more control of the finer settings and configurations of the phone, giving you much better tweaking power. However, Xposed requires access to the Android system at the root level.

To root your phone, follow the instructions given in the link [<http://>

digit.in/ACRoot]. Make sure to read the correct instructions for your handset and take extra care for OEMs who discourage rooting. For the sake of this workshop, we'll be using an international version of the OnePlus 3 running OnePlus' custom OxygenOS 3.0.

After rooting your phone and installing SuperSU and getting a custom recovery in place, you can begin installing the Xposed firmware. You should note that some apps check for the installation of the Xposed framework and might even disable access to the app until you uninstall Xposed. Apps like Snapchat and Android Pay are notorious for this. The Xposed framework and rooting an android device in general lowers the security rating of your phone and may void your manufacturer warranty.

To install Xposed, follow these steps:

- 1) You'll need to download two files from the xposed website <http://digit.in/XpsdFrmwrk>. SDK21 is Android 5.0, SDK22 is Android 5.1 and SDK 23 is Android Marshmallow 6.0. Next, you'll see the various processor architectures like arm, arm64 and x86. While x86 refers explicitly to Intel's mobile chips, arm and arm64 are the most common

versions. If your processor architecture is a 64-bit system, you should select arm64 and arm if it is 32 bit. The processor architecture can be quickly verified with a google search. After selecting, we download the latest version of Xposed (at the time of writing this workshop) in zip format, v76. Before installing, you should refer to the official Xposed thread on xda-developers [<http://digit.in/XpsdXDA>] to download the uninstaller zip and the app. The Xposed uninstaller is just in case something goes wrong.

- 2) Once you have obtained these files, you should install the app and let it run. Now, copy the two other files onto your Android phone and then reboot into the recovery mode. Once you are in your custom recovery menu, you should select any option that says 'Install ZIP' and navigate to the location where you copied the installer file. Xposed will now install successfully and if not, you can redo the steps to make sure you are doing them correctly.
- 4) After installing, Wipe your Cache and Dalvik partition and reboot your phone. When you successfully boot your phone and open the